



A few of Mohan Reddy's favourites

Book: Good to Great by Jim Collins

Movie: Baahubali; recommends Malayali cinema

Actress: Mrunal Thakur

Actor: Dulquer Salman

Food: Steamed rice with fish curry

Vehicle: His Mercedes

trepreneur and build my business," he says. Driven and dedicated, the Hyderabad Management Association recognised his achievements and facilitated him with the Entrepreneur of the Year award in 1996.

A charmer that he has always been, from charming his teachers to his customers, Mohan smiles as he says, "I continue to charm everyone, and my customers love me!" Recalling his first big customer contract, he narrates, "I convinced Ed Crowe, the senior vice-president of Pratt and Whitney, that our company was the best choice for business, over a glass of Golconda Ruby red wine. This was back in 2000 when wine wasn't popular in the country; my friends used to joke that the wine I drank was chemical and not real," he laughs, recalling the incident.

Crowe walked into Mohan's office the morning after and awarded him the contract. "When I asked what impressed him the most, he said, 'Your honesty and the stories you narrated.' He chose our small company over larger competitors for the project. Since then, over 1000 people have been engaged through this account, which is currently a \$100 million account for us!" he proudly states.

So, how does he keep up with the hustle at 73? "I make it a point to exercise daily and keep myself sharp. An hour and a half of daily exercise with half-hour on stretching, half hour on the cross-trainer and another half hour on stationary

bike. I wake up at 6:30 am and follow a strict exercise routine while watching BBC from 6:30 AM to 7:00 AM, India Today from 7:00 AM to 7:30 AM, and then some Telugu news while answering emails and messages till 8:00 AM. After which I have a

cup of steaming south Indian filter coffee and between 9:00 AM to 9:30 AM, I head to the office," he smiles as he reveals the secret to his charm.

While Mohan's life has been an ongoing pursuit of excellence, failures on the way did not discourage him. Mohan shares an incident where a former employee was involved in a terrorist attack at Glasgow Airport. This incident led to unwarranted media scrutiny, alleging that Indian companies harboured terrorists. "Despite such challenges, we maintained transparency with our customers, assuring them of the background checks we conducted on all our employees. This strengthened our trust with clients," he says.

Choosing to persevere over giving up, Mohan refused to let any obstacle stop him from reaching the pinnacle of success. "Failures are not setbacks but opportunities to learn and grow. I compete with myself. What I achieve today, I must surpass tomorrow, and each subsequent effort must be better than the last. This pursuit of excellence defines my approach and sets me apart. Challenges will inevitably arise, but I embrace them as part of the natural process," he declares.

Mohan held the reins of his flourishing business for twenty years before preparing to hand them over to his son, Krishna. "Despite physical differences—my son being much taller than me structurally—people often remark on how similar we are

in values and demeanour," he smiles.

Acknowledging the company's progress because of his son's management style, he says, "As a first-generation entrepreneur, I was hands-on and meticulous, while my son, being second-generation, delegates more and operates on a different platform. His approach led to faster growth for the company compared to my cautious and conservative style."

A remarkable legacy

With more than 15 awards, including the Padma Shri in 2017 for his contributions to the Indian industry and more than 10 honorary doctorates, BVR Mohan Reddy has won multiple accolades. Despite that, he believes, "What you leave behind is not your name, but what you do."

After years of running on the job, he has dedicated his life to transforming the electronics ecosystem with his knowledge and experience. From chairing education councils to being an administrator at reputed educational institutions, Mohan strives for excellence in education for all. "I ensured my kids studied hard and went to reputed institutions. My driver's children have been studying on my account for years. His eldest daughter is set to graduate class 12, and I am worrying about college admissions for her as well," he shares.

With an unflinching belief in his dreams, armed with his education and diligence to work his way to the top, Mohan Reddy has created a legacy for future entrepreneurs willing to do what it takes to achieve success and learn from his life.

"Life isn't always easy, but I find meaning in every situation. Life offers two choices—to surrender or keep striving. I return each day with renewed determination to overcome challenges and uphold my values," he concludes. **EFY**